DELIVERABLE 6

PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION ETHICS SOP

Prepared by Aimax Digital

For Luxe by Madiha — Clothing Brand

Document control	Details
Document number	SOP-COM-006
Version	1.0 — Blue & White Edition
Effective date	[Insert date upon approval]
Policy owner	Management / Human Resources
Approved by	[Authorized representative]
Review cycle	Annually and after a significant incident or policy change

DESIGN STANDARD: White backgrounds with blue headings, table headers, borders, and accents only.

1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) establishes expectations for respectful, clear, timely, secure, and professional communication at Luxe by Madiha. It supports effective teamwork, customer trust, responsible handling of information, and a workplace free from harassment or intimidation.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to employees, management, interns, temporary staff, contractors, consultants, and anyone communicating on behalf of Luxe by Madiha. It covers in-person and remote communication, official email, telephone calls, meetings, workplace messaging platforms, and communication with customers, suppliers, agencies, and other business partners.

3. Core communication principles

• Respect: treat colleagues, customers, suppliers, and partners with courtesy and dignity.
• Clarity: communicate the purpose, relevant facts, requested action, owner, and deadline.
• Professionalism: use appropriate language and tone; avoid insults, threats, humiliation, gossip, and aggressive or discriminatory remarks.
• Accuracy: verify information before sharing; correct errors promptly.
• Accountability: meet commitments, communicate delays early, and document important decisions.
• Confidentiality: share business and personal information only with authorized people for legitimate purposes.

4. Official email etiquette

• Use an approved business email account for business matters; avoid personal accounts for confidential work.
• Use a clear subject line that reflects the topic or action required.
• Begin with an appropriate greeting and keep the message concise, courteous, and organized.
• State the purpose, relevant context, requested action, responsible person, and deadline where applicable.
• Check recipient names, addresses, attachments, links, spelling, and confidentiality before sending.
• Use Reply All only when every recipient needs the response. Do not forward confidential threads without authorization.
• Avoid writing in all caps, hostile wording, sarcasm, or emotionally charged messages. Pause and review before sending a difficult message.
• Use an approved signature with role and company contact details, where provided.

5. Telephone and voice-call etiquette

• Answer promptly when practical and identify yourself and the business where appropriate.
• Speak clearly, calmly, and respectfully; listen without interrupting.
• Confirm key details such as names, dates, quantities, prices, delivery commitments, and next steps.
• If you cannot answer, explain that you will check and provide a realistic time for follow-up.
• Ask permission before placing a caller on hold; return promptly or offer a call-back.
• Do not record calls unless lawful, authorized, and any required notice or consent has been obtained.
• Log important customer commitments, complaints, and decisions in the approved system.

6. Meeting etiquette

• Share the purpose and agenda in advance for planned meetings; invite only necessary participants.
• Join on time, prepare relevant information, and test audio/video when required.
• Allow participants to finish speaking; disagree with ideas respectfully, not with personal attacks.
• Keep discussion relevant and protect confidential information from people who are not authorized to hear it.
• Identify decisions, actions, owners, and deadlines before the meeting ends.
• The meeting organizer or assigned note-taker should circulate a brief summary, normally within one business day.
• If unable to attend, notify the organizer and provide input or nominate an appropriate delegate when needed.

7. Messaging and collaboration platforms

• Use approved work channels for official decisions and business instructions. Keep personal and work conversations appropriately separated.
• Keep messages brief, clear, and respectful. Include context when a message may otherwise be misunderstood.
• Avoid repeated non-urgent messages outside working hours; urgent contact should be limited to genuine business needs and established arrangements.
• Do not share customer details, passwords, private documents, or confidential business information in unauthorized groups or channels.
• Do not use disappearing messages or informal chats as the sole record of important approvals, financial commitments, employment matters, or customer promises.
• If a discussion becomes heated, pause and move to a calm conversation with an appropriate manager or HR contact.

8. Language, tone, and response-time expectations

Communication type	Expected standard
Internal email / routine message	Acknowledge within one business day where a response or action is required.
Customer or supplier enquiry	Acknowledge within one business day during business hours; aim to respond sooner when practical.
Urgent operational issue	Use the designated urgent channel and notify the responsible manager promptly.
Meeting action / commitment	Confirm the owner and deadline during the meeting or in the written summary.
Complex enquiry	Acknowledge promptly, explain that further checking is needed, and give a realistic update time.

These are default service standards. Management may set stricter response times for customer service or operational roles. Response-time expectations do not require employees to monitor messages outside agreed working hours except where an approved on-call or urgent-duty arrangement applies.

Use inclusive, neutral, and professional language. Avoid discriminatory comments, slurs, sexual remarks, intimidation, humiliating jokes, or language intended to silence or demean another person.

9. Confidentiality and information protection

• Share information only with people who need it for an authorized business purpose.
• Verify recipients before sending files, reports, customer details, pricing, contracts, or staff information.
• Use approved storage, access controls, and sharing permissions; do not use public links for restricted files unless authorized.
• Never share passwords, verification codes, or another person’s private messages without a legitimate and authorized reason.
• Discuss confidential matters privately, not in public areas or open group chats.
• Report misdirected emails, lost devices, unauthorized disclosures, or suspected account compromise promptly through the designated incident process.

10. Respectful communication and anti-harassment

Luxe by Madiha expects a workplace in which people can communicate without harassment, bullying, discrimination, threats, or retaliation. Prohibited conduct includes, but is not limited to:

- Insults, repeated belittling, intimidation, threats, or deliberate public humiliation.
- Unwanted sexual comments, advances, images, or messages.
- Abusive or discriminatory language or conduct related to a protected or personal characteristic.
- Repeated unwanted contact after a person has asked it to stop.
- Retaliation against someone who raises a concern, participates in an investigation, or seeks help in good faith.

Concerns will be handled as discreetly as practicable, shared only with those who need to respond, and reviewed fairly. Confidentiality cannot be guaranteed absolutely where disclosure is necessary to investigate or address a concern. No person should be punished for making a good-faith report; knowingly false or malicious reports may be addressed through a fair process.

11. Conflict resolution and escalation

Level	When to use	Action
1 — Direct resolution	Routine misunderstanding or low-level disagreement where it is safe and appropriate.	Discuss privately and respectfully; focus on facts, impact, and a practical solution.
2 — Manager / HR support	Issue remains unresolved, affects work, or involves repeated disrespect.	Raise the matter with the line manager or designated HR contact; document relevant facts.
3 — Formal escalation	Harassment, discrimination, threats, retaliation, serious misconduct, or significant confidentiality breach.	Report promptly to senior management or the designated reporting contact; do not require direct confrontation with the person involved.
Urgent safety risk	Immediate threat, violence, or risk of harm.	Move to safety and contact appropriate emergency services or authorized security personnel.

A manager receiving a concern should listen without judgment, record the key facts, explain the next steps, protect against retaliation, and refer the matter to an impartial decision-maker when there is a conflict of interest.

12. Reporting inappropriate communication

Reports may be made to the line manager, designated HR representative, or senior management. If the concern involves one of these people, report to another appropriate senior contact. Include dates, channels, people involved, relevant messages or documents, witnesses if any, and the outcome or support requested. Do not circulate allegations broadly or conduct an unauthorized investigation.

Management should acknowledge a report promptly, assess urgency and safety, preserve relevant evidence, determine an impartial review process, and communicate outcomes to the extent appropriate and lawful.

13. Documentation of decisions and commitments

Important decisions and commitments must be recorded in an approved business system or written channel. This includes pricing or discount approvals, campaign decisions, delivery promises, supplier terms, project scope, deadlines, customer complaint outcomes, policy exceptions, and assigned actions.

A useful decision record includes: date; topic; decision; approving person; reason or key context; action owner; deadline; dependencies; and follow-up status. Meeting notes should distinguish confirmed decisions from proposals or discussion points. If a commitment changes, notify affected people promptly and update the record.

14. Breaches and corrective action

Failure to follow this SOP may lead to coaching, training, a formal warning, access restrictions, or other proportionate action under the company's applicable policies and local law. Serious misconduct may require immediate escalation. Any review should be fair, evidence-based, consistent, and proportionate to the conduct and circumstances.

15. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
All personnel	Follow this SOP, protect confidential information, communicate respectfully, and raise concerns in good faith.
Managers / team leads	Model professional conduct, set clear expectations, resolve routine issues fairly, document actions, and escalate serious matters.
HR / designated reporting contact	Receive concerns, maintain appropriate records, coordinate fair reviews, and help prevent retaliation.
Management	Approve the policy, provide training and reporting routes, and review significant incidents and recurring issues.

16. Training, records, and review

Personnel should receive this SOP during onboarding and when material updates are made. Relevant records may include training acknowledgements, meeting summaries, business decisions, complaints, investigation records, and corrective actions. Access to sensitive records must be restricted and retention should follow the company's approved retention schedule and applicable law.

Review this SOP at least annually and after a significant incident, change in communication tools, or change in applicable legal requirements.

17. Acknowledgement and approval

Approval / acknowledgement	Name / signature	Date
Luxe by Madiha — Authorized Representative	[Enter]	[Enter]
Aimax Digital — Authorized Representative	[Enter]	[Enter]
Employee / Contractor acknowledgement (if applicable)	[Enter]	[Enter]

Document note: This is a practical policy template. Before adoption, management should confirm reporting contacts, working hours, applicable employment requirements, and any local legal obligations.